全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 32 單元 | 語言與表達 · Language & Expression

Five Tricks to Fix Your Pronunciation

改善發音的五個訣竅

Many students in Taiwan can read an English text well but feel nervous when they open their mouths. If your teacher has ever warned you that nobody could understand your "comfortable" or "vegetable," do not feel bad. Pronunciation is a skill, and like any skill, it can be trained. Here are five tricks that I recommend to my students.

First, count the syllables. English words have a rhythm, and most mistakes happen when learners add or drop a syllable. "Chocolate," for example, has two syllables in everyday usage, not three. Clap your hands once for each syllable while you say the word, and you will surely hear the difference. Second, pay attention to vowels. The vowel in "ship" is short, but the vowel in "sheep" is long. Unless you can hear the difference, you cannot produce it, so listen to the two words again and again before you repeat them.

Third, learn verbs and nouns in pairs. The verb "record" and the noun "record" are spelled the same, but the stress is different. Fourth, recite short poems or song lines that rhyme. Rhyme forces your mouth to make the same sounds repeatedly, and the tune helps you remember the correct tone. Avoid slang at the beginning, because slang changes quickly and is often pronounced in unusual ways. Finally, whisper. When you whisper a sentence, you cannot rely on your voice, so your lips and tongue must do all the work. Unfortunately, most learners skip this step because it feels silly.

To summarize, good pronunciation does not come from a dictionary alone. It comes from your ears, your mouth, and daily practice. Try these tricks for a month, and then record yourself. The result will reveal how far you have come.

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
pronunciation	*n.*	發音	His pronunciation improved after he joined the drama club. 他加入戲劇社後，發音進步了。

syllable	*n.*	音節	The word "banana" has three syllables. 「banana」這個字有三個音節。
vowel	*n.*	母音	There are five vowel letters in the English alphabet. 英文字母中有五個母音字母。
recite	*v.*	朗誦；背誦	Each student had to recite a poem in front of the class. 每個學生都必須在全班面前朗誦一首詩。
rhyme	*v.*	押韻	"Cat" rhymes with "hat." 「cat」和「hat」押韻。
tone	*n.*	語調；語氣	Her tone was friendly, so nobody felt nervous. 她的語氣很友善，所以沒有人感到緊張。
slang	*n.*	俚語	Teenagers often use slang that their parents do not understand. 青少年常用父母聽不懂的俚語。
whisper	*v.*	低聲說；耳語	Please whisper in the library. 在圖書館裡請小聲說話。
summarize	*v.*	總結；摘要	Can you summarize the story in three sentences? 你能用三句話總結這個故事嗎？
unless	*conj.*	除非	You will not pass the test unless you study. 除非你讀書，否則你不會通過考試。

片語 Phrases

pay attention to	注意	Pay attention to the stress of each word. 注意每個字的重音。
rely on	依靠	Do not rely on translation apps all the time. 不要一直依賴翻譯軟體。
again and again	一遍又一遍	She listened to the song again and again. 她一遍又一遍地聽那首歌。

文法與句型 Grammar

Unless＋S＋V, S＋V（除非……否則……）

unless 等於 if ... not，引導條件子句，表示「除非」。文中 Unless you can hear the difference, you cannot produce it 意思是「除非你聽得出差別，否則發不出來」。

Unless it rains, we will practice outside.

除非下雨，否則我們會在戶外練習。

S＋can/must＋be＋p.p.（含情態動詞的被動語態）

情態動詞後接 be + 過去分詞，表示「可以被／必須被……」。文中 it can be trained 表示「發音是可以被訓練的」。

This word can be pronounced in two ways.

這個字可以用兩種方式發音。

讀完文章後，請到「皇家大衛英文閱讀集點站」完成本單元測驗，答對即可累積點數。